

NatWest Interview Experience

NatWest Group is a prominent UK-based banking and financial services company, serving over 19 million customers across retail, commercial, and private banking markets. As the group's Global Capability Centre, NatWest Group India plays a vital role in driving innovation and providing world-class services and solutions to support the bank's global customer base.

Role Offered: Software Engineer

Sequence of Selection:

1. Online Test
 2. Technical + HR Interview (Offline)
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Online Test

The online assessment consisted of four sections:

- **Coding:** This section contained two easy-level questions based on arrays and strings.
 - **Problem 1:** A problem related to finding the sum of elements at alternate indexes in an array.
 - **Problem 2:** Given a vehicle number (can be a positive or negative integer), determine its "track number." The track number is the smallest numerical permutation of the vehicle number's digits, which should not start with a leading zero.
 - **SQL:** This section contained 15 easy multiple-choice questions. No query writing was required.
 - **Aptitude:** This section focused on business aptitude and visual reasoning, including questions on scheduling tasks, counting figures, interpreting pie charts, and identifying missing figures in a pattern.
 - **English Proficiency:** This section covered general English skills, including grammar, vocabulary, and reading comprehension.
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Interview Round (Offline - 1 Hour)

The interview was conducted in-person with a panel of two interviewers and lasted for approximately one hour. The discussion flowed as follows:

- **Resume Walkthrough & Project Discussion:** The interviewers started by asking me to give a brief about my resume. They then asked me to explain one of my projects in detail.
 - **Project:** I explained my E-Commerce Recommendation System project.
 - **Follow-up Questions:** They asked about the choice of tech stack and the biggest challenge I faced. They also noted the absence of a Machine Learning project on my resume and asked if I was not interested in ML. I explained that I had completed an

ML project but chose to feature other real-world projects on my resume, and then I briefly explained the ML project as well.

- **Positional Experience (CSEA):** The interviewers asked about my role as the **Logistics Office Bearer** for the **Computer Science Engineering Association (CSEA)**. They asked me to describe the association and my specific contributions to it.
- **Data Structures Problem (Strings):**
 - **Problem:** "Print all characters that appear only once in a given string."
 - **My Approach:** I initially suggested a solution using a HashMap in Java. However, the interviewers added a constraint not to use any inbuilt collection classes. I then pivoted to a solution using two loops and a frequency counter array to keep track of repeated characters. They asked if this was the most optimized solution under the given constraint, to which I replied that it was the best I could think of at the moment.
- **SQL Query:** Before the question, they asked me to rate my skills in SQL.
 - **Problem:** Given a single table with columns (emp_id, date, status), write a query to display the details of all employees who had a "present" status for at least three consecutive days.
 - **My Approach:** I explained and wrote a query using a self-join on the same table twice to solve the problem.
- **Behavioral & Situational Questions:** The interviewers then asked a few HR-style questions:
 - "Describe yourself."
 - "Explain a situation which made your friend move in a completely different direction."
 - "Explain a situation where you had to take responsibility for a team."
- **OOP Concepts:** The final technical discussion was on Object-Oriented Programming, where I was asked to explain the four pillars of OOP (Encapsulation, Abstraction, Inheritance, and Polymorphism) using real-world examples.

At the end of the interview, I asked the interviewers about the tech stack used at the company and the potential work location.

Results

The results were announced on the same day. 9 students were selected for a direct full-time offer.

Takeaways

- **Strong knowledge** in DSA, OS, CN, DBMS, and OOPS is required.
- **Prepare your self-introduction well.** Try to include your interests, the tech stacks you know, the projects you have done, and any achievements you have.

- For DSA questions, **don't jump directly to the optimal solution**. First, explain the brute-force solution along with its time and space complexity, then move to the optimal solution, highlighting why it is better. Even if you don't know the exact solution, share your thought process.
 - Be **well-prepared on your projects**—know them in detail, including challenges faced and how you solved them.
 - Always prepare a **few questions to ask the interviewer** at the end of the round.
 - Be **confident and be prepared**.
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Resources I Followed

- **DSA:** Striver's SDE Sheet and Striver's YouTube videos.
 - **OS, DBMS, OOPS, CN:** GeeksForGeeks, InterviewBit, and similar online platforms.
 - **Language Specific:** If Java is your coding language, have in-depth knowledge and prepare it from GeeksForGeeks and other platforms as well.
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A Personal Note:

This was my fourth interview in total (2 during internships and 2 during placements, and I didn't get an internship offer either). So, don't lose hope. Give your best, as better things are coming for you at the right time. Keep learning, preparing, and making yourself better than you were yesterday.

Best of Luck!

Feel free to contact me; I will be more than happy to help.

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